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» INTERVIEW

« ODI World Cup performance altered Afghanistan's T20-centric reputation »

NAVEEN-UL-HAQ

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It is a sunny Saturday afternoon at the Holkar Stadium in Indore, and Naveen-ul-Haq has just completed his training for the second T20I against India.

The young Afghan fast bowler obliges a few fans with selfies and autographs before joining his teammates in a huddle. India, which had already clinched the series with a match to spare, won the third T20I

in Bengaluru after two thrilling Super Overs to effect a 3-0 clean sweep.

Naveen-ul-Haq could snap up just one wicket in two matches, but it has been a rewarding 12 months for him and Afghanistan, whose dazzling run in the 2023 ODI Cricket World Cup — where it beat former champions England, Pakistan and Sri Lanka — captivated fans.

Sportstar caught up with the

24-year-old right-arm medium pacer.

Could you share the journey from leading Afghanistan's U-19 team to becoming the pace spearhead of the senior side?

It has been a great journey, and I am humbled to have achieved whatever I could thus far. Hopefully, I will be able to work harder to achieve many more things for my country. The